

Absolutely — **layer** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it visually and artistically:

> “...the soft **layers** of blue, green, and purple...”

Here **layers** means **separate bands/coats/effects of colour placed over or beside one another**, but the word also covers **physical layers, clothing, geology, food, software/computing, organizational structure, sound/design, and the verb layer**.

Word family: **layer / layered / layering**

Base word: layer

Plural: layers

Verb forms: layer, layers, layered, layering

Related forms: layered, layering

Useful compounds / extensions: layer of paint, clothing layer, cloud layer, data layer, application layer, layer cake

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your source sentence:

> “...the soft **layers** of blue, green, and purple...”

Meaning in your passage: **layer = one band/coating/effect placed over or among others — 層次；一層**

Here **layers** means:

> **separate visual bands or applications of colour that build up the painting’s overall appearance.**

繁體中文：

不同顏色一層層疊加、交疊或分布形成的視覺層次

Natural translation:

> “the soft layers of blue, green, and purple”

「柔和交疊的藍、綠、紫色**層次**」

So here:

> **layer = 色彩上的一層 / 層次**

1. **layer** = thin sheet/level of material over another — 層；薄層

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “There was a thin **layer** of dust on the frame.”

「畫框上有一層薄薄的**灰塵**。」

Practice 2

> “The ground was covered with a layer of snow.”

「地面覆蓋著一**層雪**。」

layer = 覆蓋在另一表面之上的一層薄物質

2. **layer** = one level among several stacked levels — 層；層次

A broader physical sense.

Practice 3

> “The cake has three **layers**.”

「這個蛋糕有三**層**。」

Practice 4

> “The wall was built in several layers.”

「這面牆由幾個**層次 / 層面**構成。」

layer = 多層結構中的其中一層

3. **layer** = colour/paint application — 顏色層；塗層

This is very close to your source use.

Practice 5 — Original

> “I noticed the soft **layers** of blue, green, and purple.”

「我留意到藍、綠、紫色柔和交疊的**色彩層次**。」

Practice 6

> “The artist built the image with several thin layers of paint.”

「畫家用幾層薄薄的顏料**疊出**整個畫面。」

layer — art = 一層顏料、色彩或視覺效果，與其他層疊加形成整體畫面

4. **layer = clothing worn over/under other clothing — 衣物的一層；一層衣服**

A very common everyday use.

Practice 7

> “Wear an extra **layer** if it gets cold.”

「如果天氣變冷，就多穿一**層衣服**。」

Practice 8

> “She wore several layers under her coat.”

「她在外套裡穿了好幾**層衣服**。」

layer — clothing = 疊穿衣物中的一件 / 一層

5. **layer = stratum in earth/rock — 地層；岩層**

A common geology sense.

Practice 9

> “The rock contains several visible **layers**.”

「這塊岩石有幾個清楚可見的**岩層**。」

Practice 10

> “Scientists studied the deeper layers of soil.”

「科學家研究較深的**土層**。」

****layer — geology = 土壤、岩石等中按深度 / 年代形成的一層****

6. ****layer = atmospheric/cloud level — 大氣層；雲層****

A common science/weather use.

Practice 11

> “A thick ****layer of cloud**** covered the sky.”

「一大片厚厚的****雲層****覆蓋天空。」

Practice 12

> “The ozone layer protects Earth from ultraviolet radiation.”

「****臭氧層****保護地球免受紫外線傷害。」

****layer — atmosphere = 大氣、雲或氣體中的一個高度層級****

7. ****layer = one level of meaning / complexity — 層面；層次****

A major figurative meaning.

Practice 13

> “The painting has several ****layers of meaning****.”

「這幅畫有多重****意義層次****。」

Practice 14

> “The story becomes richer as new layers are revealed.”

「隨著新的****層次****被揭示，故事變得更豐富。」

****layer — figurative = 某事物中彼此重疊、逐步深入的意義、內容或複雜度****

This is especially common in:

- * literature
- * art
- * psychology
- * analysis

8. ****layer = organizational/system level — 層級；層次****

A common abstract/business/technical sense.

Practice 15

> “The company has too many management ****layers****.”

「這家公司有太多管理****層級****。」

Practice 16

> “The system adds another layer of approval.”

「這個制度又增加了一層****審批層級****。」

****layer = 組織、流程或系統中的一個等級 / 階層****

9. ****layer = software/network architecture level — 層；協議層****

A major technology sense.

Practice 17

> “The application ****layer**** handles user-facing services.”

「應用****層****負責面向使用者的服務。」

Practice 18

> “Security can be added at several layers of the system.”

「系統可以在多個****層級****加入安全措施。」

****layer — computing = 軟件、網絡或系統架構中的一個功能層級****

Common:

- * application layer
- * network layer
- * data layer
- * presentation layer

10. ****layer = data/map/design level — 圖層；資料層****

A very common design/GIS/software sense.

Practice 19

> “Put the text on a separate ****layer****.”

「把文字放在獨立的****圖層****上。」

Practice 20

> “The map has separate layers for roads and buildings.”

「地圖把道路和建築分成不同****圖層****。」

****layer — graphics/GIS = 可獨立編輯、顯示或隱藏的一組視覺 / 資料內容****

This is especially important in:

- * Photoshop
- * GIS
- * design software
- * mapping

11. ****layer = sound/music track/effect — 聲音層次；音軌層****

A common music/audio extension.

Practice 21

> “The song has many ****layers**** of sound.”

「這首歌有很多不同的**聲音層次**。」

Practice 22

> “The producer added another vocal layer.”

「製作人再加了一層**人聲音軌**。」

****layer — audio = 疊加在一起、共同形成整體聲音的其中一部分****

12. ****layer = food layer — 食物層；夾層****

Practice 23

> “Add a layer of cream between the cakes.”

「在蛋糕之間加一**層忌廉**。」

Practice 24

> “The dessert has layers of fruit and yogurt.”

「這份甜品由水果和乳酪一**層層**組成。」

****layer — food = 食物中水平疊放的一層材料****

13. ****layer = hair cut at different lengths — 層次髮型；頭髮層次****

A common beauty/hair sense.

Practice 25

> “She asked for more ****layers**** in her hair.”

「她要求把頭髮剪出更多**層次**。」

Practice 26

> “Layers can make thick hair feel lighter.”

「剪出**層次**可以讓厚髮看起來更輕盈。」

****layers — hair = 將頭髮剪成不同長度所形成的層次****

14. ****layer = verb, put things in layers — 分層放置；一層層鋪****

Now ****layer**** is a verb.

Practice 27

> “****Layer**** the vegetables in the dish.”

「把蔬菜****一層層鋪****在碟裡。」

Practice 28

> “She **layered** the blankets for extra warmth.”

「她把毯子****一層層疊起來****增加保暖。」

****layer — verb = 把多個東西按層次疊放 / 排列****

15. ****layer = verb, wear several clothes together — 疊穿****

A major clothing verb use.

Practice 29

> “It is easier to stay warm if you **layer** your clothes.”

「把衣服****分層疊穿****會比較容易保暖。」

Practice 30

> “She **layered** a sweater under the coat.”

「她在外套裡****疊穿****了一件毛衣。」

****layer clothes = 把幾件衣物按內外層次穿上****

16. ****layer = verb, build visual/sound effects gradually — 疊加；層疊****

A major art/design/audio verb use.

Practice 31

> “The artist **layered** transparent colours.”

「畫家把透明色彩**層層疊加**。」

Practice 32

> “The producer layered several sounds together.”

「製作人把幾種聲音**疊加在一起**。」

layer — creative verb = 把多個視覺、聲音或效果重疊組合

This directly relates to your Monet passage.

17. **layered = consisting of several layers — 多層的；有層次的**

Practice 33

> “The painting has a **layered** surface.”

「這幅畫的表面有很豐富的**層次**。」

Practice 34

> “She wore a layered outfit.”

「她穿了一套**多層次搭配**的衣服。」

layered = 由多層構成 / 有明顯層次的

18. **layered = complex / having several meanings — 多層次的；複雜而豐富的**

A major figurative adjective.

Practice 35

> “The novel has a **layered** meaning.”

「這本小說的意義很多****層次****。」

Practice 36

> “Her performance was subtle and layered.”

「她的表演細膩而且****富有層次****。」

****layered — figurative = 內容、意義、情感或表現包含多個相互重疊層面****

19. ****layering = act/style of building in layers — 分層；疊加；層疊****

Practice 37

> “The artist uses careful ****layering**** of colour.”

「畫家仔細運用色彩****層疊****。」

Practice 38

> “Layering is useful in cold weather.”

「寒冷天氣下，****分層穿衣****很有用。」

****layering = 把衣物、顏色、聲音、材料等一層層加入的做法****

Important distinction: ****layer vs level****

****layer****

suggests something stacked/overlapping.

****level****

suggests position, degree, or rank.

> layer of paint

> = 一層油漆

> management level

> = 管理層級

They overlap in systems, but imagery differs.

Important distinction: **layer** vs **surface**

You already have **surface** mapped.

surface

= outer/top boundary.

layer

= one thickness/stratum within or on top of something.

> surface of the painting

> = 畫作表面

> layer of paint

> = 一層顏料

A layer can sit beneath another layer; the surface is only the exposed outer part.

Important distinction: **layer** vs **coat**

coat

especially:

a layer of paint/varnish applied in one application.

layer

broader:

any one stratum of material.

> two coats of paint

> = 塗了兩遍油漆

> layers of paint

> = 多層油漆

Coat emphasizes an application; **layer** emphasizes structure.

Important distinction: **layer vs sheet**

sheet

a separate thin flat piece.

layer

may be a continuous thickness not separable as one object.

> sheet of paper

> = 一張紙

> layer of dust

> = 一層灰塵

Important distinction: **layer vs tier**

layer

physical/abstract stratum.

tier

ranked level, often one above another.

> layers of paint

> = 顏料層

> pricing tiers

> = 價格級別

In organizations:

* layer can emphasize bureaucracy

* tier can emphasize formal ranking

Important distinction: **layer vs dimension**

layer

different stratum/aspect, often stacked conceptually.

dimension

different aspect or measurable perspective.

> layers of meaning

> = 一層層意義

> dimensions of the problem

> = 問題的不同面向

Close, but not identical.

Important distinction: **layer vs depth**

layer

one part within a multi-part structure.

depth

overall degree of complexity/profundity.

> layered character

> = 有多個層次的角色

> character with depth

> = 有深度的角色

Important distinction: **layer vs layer of colour in your passage**

Your phrase:

> “soft layers of blue, green, and purple”

does not necessarily mean clearly separated horizontal stripes.

It suggests:

> ****色彩一層層交疊、滲透、形成柔和視覺層次****

So Chinese ****層次**** is more natural than mechanically translating every instance as 「層」.

Important distinction: ****layered vs complicated****

****layered****

often positive/neutral:
many meaningful levels.

****complicated****

means difficult to understand because many parts interact.

> layered novel

> = 富有層次的小說

> complicated novel

> = 情節 / 結構複雜的小說

Not the same evaluation.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* ****layer — physical thin stratum**** = 一層

* ****layer — stacked level**** = 層

* ****layer — art/paint**** = 色彩層 / 顏料層

* ****layer — clothing**** = 一層衣物

* ****layer — geology**** = 地層 / 岩層

* ****layer — atmosphere/cloud**** = 大氣層 / 雲層

* ****layer — figurative meaning**** = 層次 / 層面

* ****layer — organization/system**** = 層級

* ****layer — computing/network**** = 系統層 / 協議層

* ****layer — graphics/GIS**** = 圖層 / 資料層

* ****layer — audio**** = 聲音層次

* ****layer — food**** = 食物層 / 夾層

* ****layers — hair**** = 頭髮層次

* ****layer — verb: stack**** = 分層鋪 / 疊

* ****layer — verb: clothing**** = 疊穿

* **layer — verb: creative effects** = 疊加 / 層疊
 * **layered — literal** = 多層的
 * **layered — figurative** = 富有多重層次的
 * **layering** = 分層 / 疊加

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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layer — physical	覆蓋在另一表面之上的一層薄物質
layer — stacked level	多層結構中的其中一層
layer — art	疊加在其他顏色 / 顏料上的一層視覺效果
layer — clothing	疊穿衣物中的一件 / 一層
layer — geology	土壤、岩石等按深度 / 形成過程排列的一層
layer — atmosphere	大氣、雲或氣體中的一個高度層級
layer — figurative	某事物中彼此重疊、逐步深入的意義或內容層次
layer — organization	組織、流程或制度中的一個階層 / 層級
layer — computing	軟件、網絡或系統架構中的一個功能層級
layer — graphics/GIS	可獨立編輯、顯示或隱藏的一組視覺 / 資料內容
layer — audio	與其他聲音疊加，共同形成整體音效的一部分
layer — food	食物中水平疊放的一層材料
layers — hair	把頭髮剪成不同長度所形成的層次
layer — verb	把多個東西按層次疊放、排列或疊加
layered — literal	由多個層次構成的
layered — figurative	內容、意義或情感具有多個相互重疊層面的
layering	把衣物、顏色、聲音、材料等一層層加入的做法

For your original sentence

> “...the soft **layers** of blue, green, and purple...”

The exact meaning is:

****layers = 藍、綠、紫等顏色不是單一平面出現，而是柔和地彼此疊加、交融，形成視覺上的層次感****

So naturally:

> **「柔和交疊的藍、綠、紫色色彩層次。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

> ****layer of dust**** → 一層灰塵

> ****layer of paint**** → 一層顏料 / 油漆

- > **clothing layer** → 一層衣服
- > **rock layer** → 岩層
- > **layer of meaning** → 意義層次
- > **software layer** → 軟件 / 系統層
- > **image layer** → 圖層
- > **layer colours** → 疊加色彩
- > **layered meaning** → 多層次意義